killed in a US drone strike in the Shawal Valley in Pakistan's Taliban-controlled tribal agency of North Waziristan (The Long War Journal, 19 November 2012).

Like other militant groups operating in IHK, the activities of HM declined after 2002.

Nevertheless, in June 2013, militants killed eight soldiers in Indian-held Kashmir in the deadliest such attack in five years, ahead of the then Indian Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's visit to this area. HM claimed responsibility for this attack (*Dawn*, 2013). After that, there was no credible report of HM's activities inside IHK. At present, it has no existence in Pakistan.

This milieu gave rise to the next three phases and different faces of terrorism, spanning over three decades, which posed a serious threat to the present security system. The following chapters will elaborate how the firm extension of earlier policies of the government threw the state into a complex situation aggravated by the participation in Afghan jihad against the Soviet Union, backlash against such policies, weak writ of the government, sectarian terrorism and external factors. These phases solidified the foundations of the edifice of religious extremism and militancy in Pakistan.